

Event Flow

Opening

- Participants arrive, teams already formed (3–5 members per team), tracks already selected (Banking, E-Commerce, Food Delivery, Dating App, Job Portal)
- Welcome and introduction to the event
- Full briefing on Phase 1 — rules, tracks, judging criteria, submission process

Phase 1 — Build the Worst System (8AM to 1PM)

- Teams build their intentionally broken system
- Mid-build review — judges walk to each team individually, assess progress
- Game runs, in between (optional)
- Teams continue building after the game
- Pre-final review — judges walk to each team again, final assessment
- They submit git repo on our website
- Top teams selected for final presentation (number based on total participants)
- Selected teams present their cursed system to everyone — framed as a fake product pitch
- Inform about Phase 1 awards, disclose and distribute at last

Lunch (1PM to 2PM)

- During this break, organizers handle track-based codebase swaps via the website (we can automate this entire process)
- Every team comes back with a link to someone else's disaster waiting for them
- Solo-track teams get an organizer-prepared cursed codebase of matching difficulty

Phase 2 — The Redemption Round (2PM to 8PM)

- Full briefing on Phase 2 — rules, judging criteria, presentation expectations
- Teams receive the swapped codebase and begin reading, diagnosing, rebuilding
- Mid-build review — judges walk to each team individually
- Game runs, in between (optional)
- Teams continue rebuilding
- Pre-final review — judges walk to each team again
- They submit git repo on our website
- Top teams selected for final presentation
- Selected teams present their full arc — original disaster, diagnosis, clean rebuild

Closing

- All awards announced together — Phase 1, Phase 2, and Overall
 - Prize distribution (depends on sponsor)
 - Event ends
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Description

Opening and Briefing

Participants are walked through exactly what FaultLine is, why it exists, and what they are expected to build. The key framing delivered here is that **Phase 1 and Phase 2 are completely independent competitions**. Not making the Phase 1 finals does not eliminate anyone. Every team that starts Phase 1 starts Phase 2. Every team has a shot at every award. This is stated clearly and explicitly so no team mentally checks out at any point during the day.

Teams are also told from the very start that their Phase 1 final presentation should be framed as a fake product pitch — present your broken disaster like it's a revolutionary startup. This framing shapes how teams build, how they think about their system, and how entertaining the final round becomes. Giving it upfront rather than as a surprise at the end means teams design toward it.

Phase 1 — Build the Worst System

Teams disperse to their workspaces and begin building. The goal is making a project with bad architecture, wrong data structures, zero modularity, spaghetti backend logic, and a frontend that is genuinely painful to use. The stack is open (web, app, terminal, any language, whatever you want, bash and shell scripts also works).

First review (Not a presentation). This gives judges early signal on who is doing interesting work, and it gives teams a checkpoint to course-correct if they're not being creative enough with their chaos.

While the mid-build review happens, the first game runs on the main stage.

After the game, teams continue building until the pre-final review. Judges make another round to each workspace. After this second review, judges convene and select the top teams for the final presentation round. The number of finalists is decided based on total participant count.

Selected teams then present to the full room (or only the total judge panel). Each presentation is a fake product pitch — teams sell their disaster as a legitimate product with confidence and commitment. The crowd watches, the judges score. Non-finalist teams watch from the audience. Phase 1 awards are not announced here — results are held until the very end of the day.

Lunch — 1:00 PM to 2:00 PM

Organizers use this hour to execute the codebase swap — assigning each team a codebase from another team in the same track via the submission portal, and notifying them with a link. Teams that registered in a track with no swap partner receive an organizer-prepared cursed codebase built to match the difficulty and chaos level of what real teams produced that morning. When participants return at 2:00 PM, their Phase 2 assignment is already waiting.

Phase 2 — The Redemption Round

Phase 2 opens with a fresh briefing. Even though participants know the broad concept, the specific rules, judging criteria, and presentation expectations for Phase 2 are different enough to warrant a clean explanation. The framing here is the opposite of Phase 1 — where Phase 1 rewarded creative destruction, Phase 2 rewards clear diagnosis, sound architecture, and clean execution.

Teams access their assigned codebase and begin the work of understanding it — reading through the code, navigating the cursed UI, figuring out what the system is supposed to do, and then planning a complete rebuild from the ground up.

The structure mirrors Phase 1 — a mid-build judge walkthrough, a simultaneous game on the main stage (optional), continued building, and a pre-final judge walkthrough. Top teams are again selected for final presentations.

The Phase 2 final presentations cover the complete arc: what the original system was, what made it a disaster, every engineering decision made during the rebuild, and the final clean product. These are judged on diagnosis quality, architecture decisions, and the contrast between before and after.

Closing and Prize Distribution

After Phase 2 presentations wrap, all awards are announced together in a single ceremony — Phase 1 awards, Phase 2 awards, and the two overall awards. The prize distribution happens immediately after the announcement, and the event closes.